



Remarkable feat: Gulveer Singh set a national record in the men's 10,000m event at the Hachioji Long Distance 2024 athletics meet in Japan, emerging as the fastest runner across eight groups with a time of 27:14.88. RITU RAJ KONWAR

shattering a 16-year-old Indian national record in the men's 10,000m, finishing second in his heat at The Ten in San Juan Capistrano, California. Gulveer then broke his own national record in the men's 5,000m, clocking 13:11.82 to win gold at the World Athletics Continental Tour in Niigata, Japan.

The Uttar Pradesh native capped off the year by improving his 10,000m record again, posting 27:14.88 to win gold at the Hachioji Long Distance 2024 athletics meet in Japan.

The pattern of near-misses continued for Neeraj beyond the Olympics, with the 27-year-old finishing second in three Diamond League events — first in Doha, then in Lausanne, followed by the final in Brussels.

He ended an injury-hindered year by changing coaches, opting to train under triple Olympic champion Jan Zelezny.

IN 2025...

The World Athletics Championship, scheduled to take place in Tokyo in September, is the event to watch out for. With no other major events on the calendar, it is nearly certain that the cream of world athletics will make its presence felt in Tokyo.

Closer on the calendar is the World Indoor Championship, slated for March in Nanjing, China. The Asian nation will also host the World Athletics Relays in May, in Guangzhou.

Additionally, 2025 will feature 15 Diamond League meets, starting with Xiamen on April 26. The league will conclude with the final in Zurich in August.

India's hopes in these global events will continue to rest heavily on Neeraj, who will rely on a prolonged recovery period as he continues his hunt for the elusive 90m mark.

For a better test of their capabilities, Indian athletes will focus on the Asian Athletics Championships, set to be hosted by South Korea from May 27 to 31.

On the domestic front, Chennai is set to host the National Inter-State Senior Athletics Championships in August, while the National Federation Senior Athletics Championships will take place in Kochi in April.